



## GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads  
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

# SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

|                              |               |                                  |            |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Date of Incident:</b>     | 13/12/2022    | <b>Time of Incident:</b>         | 11:30am    |
| <b>Region / Directorate:</b> | IDD           | <b>Main Roads or Contractor:</b> | Contractor |
| <b>EQSafe Event Type:</b>    | Near Miss     | <b>EQSafe Incident Number:</b>   | 29372      |
| <b>Actual Consequence:</b>   | Insignificant | <b>Potential Consequence:</b>    | Major      |

|                                    |                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Incident Short Description:</b> | A concrete pipe has been released, rolled down a trailer ramp and come to rest on a windrow. |
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### Executive Summary:

On 13th December 2022, a sub-contractor truck carrying culvert pipes arrived at a project site and was guided to the designated load/unload area. The supervisor for the area organised an engineer to attend to the inspection of the pipes on the truck.

The Site Supervisor upon being informed a truck with culvert pipes had arrived on site organized for a site engineer to attend to the inspection of the pipes for a quality check. The Supervisor told the engineer he would be there shortly as he was in the field dealing with another matter.

The delivery driver had initially taken the incorrect access road onto the project site and had arrived in another car park blocking vehicle access. A site worker requested the truck driver move his truck into the designated unloading area to allow access in the light vehicle area.

IT Operator arrived and called Site Supervisor via the UHF radio to ask if the pipes had been inspected for unloading. Site Engineer arrived at unloading area and began to inspect the pipes for quality as per the Site Supervisor instructions. The site Supervisor was dealing with another issue in the field at this point.

The truck driver released the straps and chains holding the pipes in place prior to the inspection being undertaken.

During the course of removing the restraints on the rear trailer the last pipe has moved from its position and rolled down the ramp to the rear of the trailer coming to rest on a windrow within the designated unloading area.

The engineer or truck driver in the line of fire and there were no other persons or machines in the zone.

**Incident Photos:**



***Pipes loaded on the trailer***



***Pipe came to rest against a windrow***

### Contributing Factors:

- Communication: Driver information for site inadequate: Arrived in car park from side access road. Did not call up prior to arriving on site and began unloading prior to safety inspection and approval.
- Designated worker for unloading process on site was off site with illness. Drainage Supervisor was not included on information emails regarding load coming to site. Site Supervisor was in the field dealing other issues at the time the truck arrived.
- Safety Inspections not completed. Site Engineer began quality check of pipe prior to safety inspection
- Individual chocks are used when securing back pipe and not a solid bar/chock across trailer. Driver was experienced however had not previously transported pipes of this size. Chock missing at rear of trailer securing pipe 3 x separate inspections completed by Supplier workers did not identify inadequate chocks or issues that could arise during unloading
- Transport driver did not identify hazards prior or during the task of removing restraints. Delivery driver began removing restraints from trailer prior to safety inspection. Culvert pipes not secured for unloading process once restraints were removed. Release of energy not identified

### Corrective Actions:

- Supplier to confirm contractors engaged to deliver materials are adequately trained as per the Load Restraint Guide 2018.
- Driver Checklist: to be provided to the supplier by the Senior Project Engineer. This checklist is to be supplied to the driver of the vehicle by the supplier. The driver is to provide this inspection upon arrival to site to the designated Inspection Supervisor.
- No work shall commence on site until the designated Supervisor has given approval.
- System to be developed to ensure all drainage deliveries on site are communicated at pre-shift meetings across the project.
- Communication to additional suppliers of event findings and actions.
- Designated area at the site to be increased to ensure traffic interaction does not occur during the delivery unloading.
- Identification of additional people on site to be trained in Chain of Responsibility and Load Restraint.
- Designated parking areas for deliveries arriving to site to be reviewed to allow vehicles to park in a fundamentally safe position without interaction of other vehicles.

### Additional Issues/Learnings:

- Importance of communication amongst all stakeholders on the project to ensure tasks are planned and safely conducted at site level.
- Contingency required in the event of individuals being off site or unavailable. The system currently relies on limited individuals for the unloading process to be a success.
- Chain of Responsibility for suppliers and contractors is critical.
- Risk Management of delivery drivers, areas to park and unloading are essential on site to ensure the areas are safe and instructions are clear for the drivers upon arrival.



#### **Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Dropped Objects.**

### Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations

